

Instructions

Welcome to DataAnnotation

DataAnnotation is a platform that pays you to make AI smarter. Your judgment, expertise, and perspective help shape how AI systems think.

AI models learn from human feedback, and the feedback that matters most isn't just a thumbs up or thumbs down. It's the kind of careful reasoning a thoughtful person brings to a hard problem: noticing where an answer goes subtly wrong, explaining why one response is genuinely better than another, catching a logical gap, or pushing a model with a question it can't easily handle. That reasoning is what trains AI systems to behave well, helping them become more accurate, helpful, and safe.

Across the platform, contributors are debugging code, writing short stories, checking medical claims, and designing prompts that probe the edges of what models can do. Some tasks take a few minutes, while others involve hours of detailed work. You'll choose projects based on your interests and qualifications, and the range of work available to you grows as you build a track record.

Quality is the whole point. When you explain why a response is wrong, or what a better one would look like, that explanation is what makes your work useful for training. To maintain high standards across the platform, your submissions will be reviewed and assessed. Strong consistency, along with accurate time reporting, keeps you in good standing and opens up access to more projects over time.

We're glad you're here. Let's get you up and running.

Overview

This is the first of three onboarding projects designed to help you get comfortable with how everything works:

Onboarding Step 1: Platform Basics

Onboarding Step 2: Getting Paid!

Onboarding Step 3: Practice Quiz

By the end of these three steps, you'll be ready to start contributing to real projects!

Navigating the Platform

Let's start by getting familiar with how the platform is organized. Looking at the top of the DataAnnotation page once you log in, you'll see a banner with a few different options. Each is explained in more detail below.

Project instructions are often presented in collapsible sections like the ones here — just click to open.

Work on Projects

Go to your Work on Projects page

The Work on Projects page is where you'll find all of the projects and tasks available for you to work on.

At the top of the page, you might see a featured project or qualification. We recommend checking this out first since it's often high-priority or a great match for you — but you're always free to start wherever you'd like.

Beneath that, you'll see the following tabs:

Projects

This section includes:

- The name of each project available to you
- The number of tasks in that project that are currently available
- The pay associated with each project

Inside a Project: The Project Task Page (click to open!)

Once you click into a project, you'll land on a project task page, which is where you'll actually complete the work — you're on a project task page right now!

Instructions

Read the instructions thoroughly and carefully! Paying close attention to the instructions is key to submitting high-quality work and succeeding on the platform.

- Additional instructions are sometimes included via hyperlinks, and might also be organized under collapsible section headings.
- You can open the instructions in a separate tab or window if that helps as you work — look for "Open instructions in a new window" at the top-right of the task.
- You can report time spent reading project instructions, as this is considered part of the work.

Timer

The timer in the bottom-right corner of the screen isn't for tracking how long you've worked — it only shows how long the task is reserved for you. When it expires, that task will be released for someone else to work on.

- The timer resets after each submission.
- Different projects have different time limits, so always keep an eye on the timer to avoid losing work.
- Use your own timekeeping method (like the timer on your phone or an app such as Clockify) to track how long you've worked on an hourly project.

Project Chat

You'll find the chat box at the bottom of each task page. The Project Chat allows you to ask the Admin questions about project-specific instructions, especially edge cases, and to exchange helpful strategies with fellow workers. From time to time, the Admins might pin important announcements, instructions or reminders at the top of the chat. In addition, we welcome you to help answer other workers' questions in the chat if it's something that is addressed in the project's instructions.

There are no notifications, so check back regularly for updates or clarifications.

Many projects also have a Slack channel associated with them where you can discuss projects in more detail. You will receive an invitation from an Admin if you are eligible to join one of those channels.

Enter Work Mode

This button does not appear on every project, but when it does, you need to click on it before you can start working on a task.

Skip

Skip tasks you're unsure about instead of guessing: If you're not confident or don't have the information needed to complete a task, it's okay to skip it. Use the Skip button — you'll find it in the top-left and bottom-left corners of the page.

Submit and Begin Next Task

Click the blue "Submit and Begin Next Task" button at the bottom of the page when you have completed a task and are ready to move on to the next one, if there are more tasks available. If you instead want to exit after completing, select "Submit and Return to Dashboard," available under the dropdown.

Exit Work Mode

Once your task is submitted, you can use the Exit Work Mode button at the bottom left of the page to end your session and free up the next task for other annotators to work on. Or, if you decide not to work on a particular project, you can use this button to release the current task so someone else can try it. Just note that once you exit or release the task, you may not be able to return to it. Clicking this button will return you to the project dashboard. This button may not be available for every project.

Qualifications

Qualifications are used to evaluate your fit for different projects on the platform. They typically involve a short assessment of your relevant skills, experience, and eligibility for the work. If you perform well on a qualification and demonstrate a strong understanding of the task, you will be approved to work on the full project, which often gives you access to work on hundreds or thousands of tasks. It's a good idea to complete the Qualifications so that you can have access to more projects!

Surveys

Surveys are short questionnaires, and we'll let you know if completing one can help open up more relevant work opportunities for you.

Report Time

We'll explain more details on how to report your time in "Onboarding Step 2: Getting Paid," but keep in mind that you will need to track and report your own time on all projects. This is not done automatically by the platform!

Transfer Funds

Go to your Transfer Funds page

This is where you will find a summary of your earnings, recent task submissions, and your recently reported time. You'll see:

- Your total lifetime earnings on the platform
- Your earnings over time
- The funds you have available to withdraw
- The funds you've earned that are still pending approval

The section in the second tab, "Funds History," lists your most recent task submissions and time entries (and the pay associated with them).

Refer & Earn

Go to your Refer & Earn page

Here you'll find information about referring people who you think might be a good fit for working with DataAnnotation. A minimum amount of earnings on the platform may be required before this tab is visible to you.

Inbox

Go to your Inbox

This is where you'll find announcements and updates regarding projects, as well as direct messages from the admin team. You should also receive an email when there is a new message in your platform inbox — unless you have disabled email notifications from DataAnnotation (which we don't recommend).

Your Name

From this dropdown, you can access the following:

Profile

Go to your Profile page

Your "Profile" page is a place where you can:

- Add additional languages you can speak
- Update your skills and background
- Add your LinkedIn profile URL
- Add licenses and credentials
- Find your Worker ID and Referral Code
- Change your contact email address
- Add your PayPal email address (not necessarily the same as your contact email!)
 - DOUBLE (OR TRIPLE!) CHECK THAT YOU'VE ENTERED THE CORRECT PAYPAL EMAIL. We have no recourse to recover funds sent to the incorrect PayPal account, and it can't be changed once you've added it!!
- Disable email notifications (which we don't recommend doing)
- Enable Two-Factor Authentication
- Update your password

We encourage you to fill out your skills and background, licenses and credentials, and LinkedIn profile URL, as this information helps us connect you with work that may be a good fit!

Support

You can always reach out to the Support team by submitting a request here.

Code of Conduct

It's crucial to read and follow our Code of Conduct.

FAQ

Find answers to administrative questions in the FAQ. We advise you to bookmark this!

Logout

Use this to logout, which should always be done if working on a public or shared computer.

Practice with Common Question Formats

Now that you've learned how to navigate the platform, here's your chance to become familiar with the different types of question formats you might come across. Give each one a try!

Sharing Screenshots

Some projects will ask you to share a screenshot. For this exercise, we'd like you to take and upload a screenshot of this section of your screen – the part you're currently reading about sharing screenshots.

The quickest and easiest way to do that is to:

- Use a keyboard shortcut that copies the screenshot directly to your clipboard.
- Click on "paste it in here" in the box below. That'll paste it immediately without you having to do anything else. In some cases, it might ask you for confirmation first.

How to take a screenshot that's copied straight to your clipboard:

On a Mac:

Press Shift + Control + Command + 4 all at the same time, then click and drag to select the area you want to capture. (This keyboard shortcut might not work if you already have a screenshot tool installed on your machine. In that case, you can use Shift + Command + 4 to save the screenshot as a file - usually on your desktop, unless you've changed the settings).

On Windows:

Press Windows + Shift + S all at the same time, then click and drag to select the area you want to capture.

Alternative Upload Options

If you saved your screenshot as a file instead, you can:

- Drag and drop it into the upload box, or
- Click to browse your computer and select it manually.

Drag a file here, click here to browse, or paste it in here

All file formats accepted

Selecting Ranking Order

Some questions might ask you to rearrange items in ranked order. You can try it out here by dragging and dropping the options below to arrange the years in ascending chronological order:

Tip: make sure to click and drag the six small dots at the left edge of each option.

1999

2008

2015

1982

2003

Tree Selection

There are also tasks where you are given a "tree" of categories and subcategories to evaluate data. Click on the category to expand the tree. If you hover over the question mark icon to the right of the subcategory, you will see examples that can help you decide.

Be sure to select a subcategory (any item with a question mark icon next to it) rather than a top-level category. Top-level categories can be expanded or collapsed using the arrows to the left of them.

Find which subcategory is the best fit for the statement below:

"One venti low-fat, extra foam, sugar-free, half-caf caramel latte please."

Type and search

Questions

General

Menu

App

Orders

Miscellaneous

Multiple Choice and Checkbox Options

You'll often be asked to pick the correct answer(s) to a question. Some questions allow only one answer, while others let you select multiple options.

Select the category that best describes the sentence below:

It is a truth universally acknowledged, that a single man in possession of a good fortune, must be in want of a wife.

Song lyric

First line of a novel

Brand jingle

None of the above

Free Response Text Fields

You'll frequently be asked to provide a rationale for the answers you've provided. Many times, you'll be asked to respond with a specific number of sentences. Be sure to follow those guidelines when answering.

Please tell us something you learned today about using the DataAnnotation platform (1-2+ sentences):

Comments/Questions?

All done?

Click Submit and Begin Next Task to return to your dashboard and move on to Onboarding Step 2: Getting Paid!

Save to account

Submit

Saved to this browser automatically. Not yet saved to your account.

Clear Response

Pin to corner

Please only leave messages if you have questions about performing the task that you need the poster to answer, if the project is broken in some way, or if you have tips or answers for other workers. If you are facing technical difficulties, have feedback about pay, or have other suggestions.

Ahmedil-2RVACVM6

9 hours ago

VishveshmarP-XM2M96M3

13 hours ago

JuanG-TGPAHR9Q

14 hours ago

GraciellangeliCA-AJPTN7C4

15 hours ago

YuxinY-ARQMCFFV

18 hours ago

IshaA-9TMQFCVT

18 hours ago

MuriloT-W7H6XKTH

19 hours ago

AchlisS-VNPY2WPR

20 hours ago

MotasemA-N6V4E93M

21 hours ago

かの人藤-P3YAZ4D6

21 hours ago

RomanH-JZHRXRF

22 hours ago

AissataB-DK0TPW40

23 hours ago

Chat with workers

Send

Code of Conduct

Support

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